



Move to Milwaukee: The 2026 Relocation Guide

Your complete step-by-step resource for moving, living, and buying a home in Metro Milwaukee. Whether you're considering a fresh start from Chicago, exploring Midwest opportunities, or simply seeking a better quality of life, this guide will help you understand everything Milwaukee has to offer.

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Welcome to Milwaukee

Where Affordability Meets Lifestyle

Thinking about a move to Milwaukee? You're not alone. Thousands are relocating each year—most from Chicago, the coasts, and major Midwest metros—drawn by affordability, lifestyle, and a genuine sense of community that's hard to find in larger cities.

Milwaukee offers something unique: the amenities and culture of a major metropolitan area without the overwhelming costs and congestion. From our stunning lakefront to thriving neighborhoods, world-class arts scene to championship sports, this city delivers an exceptional quality of life.

1,762

Net Inflow from Chicago

Annual relocations (Redfin, 2025)

27.8%

Lower Cost of Living

Compared to Chicago overall

47%

Lower Rent Prices

Significant housing savings

Let's explore if Milwaukee is your next home and how I can help make your transition seamless and stress-free.

Why People Are Moving to Milwaukee



Affordability

Homes are 30-40% cheaper compared to Chicago, allowing you to get more space, better neighborhoods, and build equity faster. Your housing budget stretches significantly further here.



Lifestyle

Enjoy lakefront access, vibrant arts and music scenes, craft breweries, and a strong sense of community. Milwaukee offers big-city amenities with a Midwestern welcome.



Jobs & Economy

Thriving healthcare, technology, and manufacturing sectors provide diverse career opportunities. Major employers are expanding and remote work options are abundant.



Perfect Location

Just a 90-minute drive to Chicago—close enough for occasional visits or work commutes, but far enough to enjoy lower costs and a more relaxed pace of life.



Real Value Comparison: A \$400,000 home in Milwaukee would cost approximately \$700,000 for comparable features and location in Chicago.

Milwaukee vs. Chicago: Cost of Living Breakdown

Understanding the financial impact of your move is crucial for making an informed decision. Here's a detailed comparison showing where your money goes further in Milwaukee versus Chicago.

Category	Milwaukee	Chicago	Difference
Overall Cost of Living	100	127.8	+27.8%
Monthly Rent	\$1,192–\$1,839	\$1,692–\$2,788	+47%
Groceries	100	119.4	+19.4%
Home Price (per sqft)	\$179	\$338	+88%

 **Bottom Line:** To maintain a \$6,000/month lifestyle in Milwaukee, you would need **\$7,667 in Chicago**. That's nearly \$20,000 per year in savings—money you can invest, save, or use to enjoy life more fully.

These savings compound over time, allowing Milwaukee residents to build wealth faster, retire earlier, or simply enjoy a higher quality of life without financial stress.

Meet Your Local Expert



Lucas Murphy

Realtor® | eXp Realty | Provision Properties

I specialize in helping out-of-state buyers relocate to Milwaukee with confidence and ease. From your first Zoom consultation to the closing table—and beyond—I provide personalized guidance every step of the way.

My approach combines deep local market knowledge with a genuine understanding of the relocation experience. I've helped dozens of families transition from Chicago and other metros, and I know exactly what questions you have and what challenges you'll face.

Whether you're exploring neighborhoods virtually, coordinating inspections remotely, or planning a discovery weekend, I'll be your advocate and trusted advisor throughout the entire process.

[Book Your Relocation Strategy Call](#)



 Calendly



Lucas Murphy

Welcome to my scheduling page. Please follow the instructions to add an event to my calendar.

Top Neighborhoods to Explore

Milwaukee's diverse neighborhoods each offer unique character, amenities, and lifestyle options. Here's a guide to help you identify which areas align best with your preferences and priorities.

Bay View

Vibe: Artsy, walkable, lakefront charm

Ideal For: Young professionals, creative types

Median Home Price: \$315,000

Trendy cafes, local breweries, and KK River waterfront dining. Close to downtown with a vibrant community feel.

Wauwatosa (Tosa)

Vibe: Family-friendly, central location

Ideal For: Families, commuters

Median Home Price: \$375,000

Excellent schools, walkable village area, easy highway access. Perfect balance of suburban comfort and urban convenience.

Brookfield

Vibe: Spacious, suburban, upscale

Ideal For: Families, executives

Median Home Price: \$475,000

Top-rated schools, large lots, excellent shopping. Professional community with low crime and strong property values.

Shorewood

Vibe: Historic, charming, tree-lined

Ideal For: Professionals, empty nesters

Median Home Price: \$425,000

Architectural diversity, walkable downtown, direct lake access. Strong sense of community with excellent local businesses.

East Side/Downtown

Vibe: Urban, social, energetic

Ideal For: First-time buyers, young professionals

Median Home Price: \$275,000

Walkable to entertainment, dining, and lakefront. Condos and historic homes near Brady Street and downtown.



Not Sure Which Fits? Take the Neighborhood Fit Quiz included in your relocation toolkit to get personalized recommendations based on your lifestyle priorities.

Schools, Lifestyle & Community



Education Excellence

Top Public School Districts:

- Brookfield School District
- Whitefish Bay
- Wauwatosa
- Nicolet High School District

Premier Private Options:

- Marquette University High School
- Divine Savior Holy Angels (DSHA)
- University School of Milwaukee
- Diverse parochial school network

Milwaukee perfectly blends urban sophistication with Midwestern warmth. Whether you're catching a show at the Marcus Performing Arts Center, exploring farmer's markets, or enjoying neighborhood festivals, there's always something happening in Milwaukee.



Culture & Recreation

World-Class Attractions:

- Summerfest - World's largest music festival
- Milwaukee Art Museum & Third Ward galleries
- Milwaukee Bucks at Fiserv Forum
- Brewers baseball at American Family Field

Outdoor Activities:

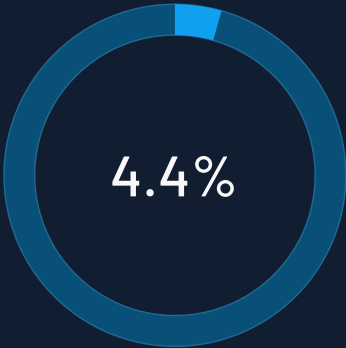
- 150+ parks throughout the county
- Oak Leaf Trail - 125-mile bike path system
- Milwaukee County Zoo
- Lake Michigan beaches and harbors

Housing Market Snapshot

Fall 2025 Market Conditions

Understanding current market dynamics helps you make informed decisions about timing, pricing, and negotiation strategy. Here's what's happening in Milwaukee's real estate market right now.

Median Sale Price	\$235,000
Days on Market	44 days
Average Offers per Listing	3



Year-Over-Year Price Growth

Steady appreciation in median home values



Additional Days on Market

Slightly longer selling times benefit buyers



Average Offers Per Listing

Competitive but manageable environment

Market Insight: Inventory is slightly rising, creating more favorable conditions for buyers. Inbound relocations from Chicago and coastal cities are increasing demand in desirable neighborhoods like Bay View, Wauwatosa, and Shorewood—making it important to act decisively when you find the right home.

This balanced market provides opportunities for negotiation while still offering competitive pricing. Strategic buyers who are prepared and well-represented can secure excellent value.

Relocation Made Easy

Your 6-Step Move Plan

Moving to a new city can feel overwhelming, but with a clear process and the right guidance, it becomes manageable and even exciting. Here's how we'll work together to make your Milwaukee relocation seamless.

01

Discovery Call

We start with an in-depth conversation about your lifestyle priorities, budget, timeline, and must-haves. This foundation ensures we focus on neighborhoods and properties that truly fit your needs.

02

Neighborhood Match

Based on your preferences, I'll provide detailed neighborhood profiles, school information, commute analysis, and lifestyle fit assessments. You'll get insider knowledge you won't find online.

03

Virtual Tours

Can't visit in person yet? No problem. I provide personalized video walkthroughs of homes and neighborhoods, giving you a genuine feel for properties before you travel to Milwaukee.

04

Offer & Negotiation

Armed with local market data and competitive analysis, we craft a strategic offer that positions you to win without overpaying. I negotiate aggressively on your behalf.

05

Inspection & Closing

I coordinate with my vetted network of inspectors, lenders, and title companies to ensure a smooth closing process. You'll have support at every checkpoint, even from out of state.

06

Welcome Home!

Your move doesn't end at closing. I provide local vendor recommendations, utility setup guidance, and neighborhood introductions to help you settle in quickly and comfortably.

Trusted Local Network

Vetted Professionals at Every Step

One of the biggest challenges of relocating is not knowing who to trust for essential services. Over years of helping families move to Milwaukee, I've built relationships with exceptional professionals who consistently deliver outstanding results.

Your relocation team includes:

- **Mortgage Lenders:** Ethan & Marty - Specialized in relocation financing, competitive rates, and smooth closings
- **Home Staging:** Kayla Hunter Interiors - Making homes show-ready for maximum value
- **Home Inspectors:** Thorough, experienced professionals who protect your investment
- **Title & Escrow:** Trusted companies ensuring clean transactions
- **Moving Companies:** Reliable movers experienced with long-distance relocations
- **Contractors:** Licensed professionals for repairs, updates, and renovations



📄 **The Advantage:** You don't need to start from scratch researching contractors and service providers. I've done the vetting for you, ensuring you work with professionals who understand relocation needs and deliver exceptional service.

This network saves you time, reduces stress, and gives you confidence that every aspect of your move is handled by competent professionals who have your best interests at heart.

Milwaukee's Job & Economy Outlook

A strong local economy and diverse employment opportunities make Milwaukee an attractive destination for career-focused professionals and families seeking long-term stability.



Healthcare

Key Employers: Froedtert Health, Aurora Health Care, Children's Wisconsin, Medical College of Wisconsin

Outlook: Consistently expanding with stable career opportunities across clinical, administrative, and research roles. Healthcare represents Milwaukee's largest employment sector.



Technology

Key Employers: Generac Power Systems, Northwestern Mutual Digital Hub, Johnson Controls, Rockwell Automation

Outlook: Growing tech ecosystem with increasing remote work opportunities. Milwaukee's lower cost of living attracts tech talent from more expensive markets.



Manufacturing

Key Employers: Harley-Davidson, Rockwell Automation, Johnson Controls, Briggs & Stratton

Outlook: Modern manufacturing renaissance with automation and advanced technology. Milwaukee remains a manufacturing powerhouse with high-paying skilled positions.



Education

Key Employers: Marquette University, Milwaukee School of Engineering (MSOE), University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee, Milwaukee Public Schools

Outlook: Diverse academic sector providing stable employment and contributing to workforce development and innovation throughout the region.

Economic Insight: Milwaukee's balanced economy combines traditional strengths in manufacturing and healthcare with emerging opportunities in technology and professional services. This diversity creates resilience and long-term stability—especially valuable when combined with significantly lower living costs.

Cost-Saving Resources for Buyers

Make Your Move Smarter and More Affordable

Beyond Milwaukee's inherent affordability advantages, numerous programs and resources can help you save even more money during your home purchase and transition.

Down Payment Assistance

- WHEDA 3% down payment assistance programs
- First-time homebuyer grants
- FHA loans with 3.5% down
- Conventional loans with as little as 3% down
- VA loans for eligible veterans (0% down)

Tax Benefits

- Homestead tax exemption reducing property taxes
- Wisconsin mortgage interest deduction
- Property tax credits for qualified buyers
- Energy efficiency rebates and credits

Essential Services Setup

- We Energies - Electric and natural gas
- Milwaukee Water Works - Municipal water
- Spectrum, AT&T - Internet and cable
- Waste Management - Refuse and recycling
- Complete utility transfer checklist included

Moving & Settling Resources

- Vetted local moving companies
- Storage facility recommendations
- Home warranty options
- Neighborhood vendor directories
- School registration assistance



Maximize Your Savings: Download the complete Move to Milwaukee Toolkit for detailed program information, application guidance, and money-saving strategies that most relocators miss.

Relocation Toolkit Overview

Everything You Need in One Comprehensive Resource

I've compiled years of relocation expertise into a comprehensive toolkit designed specifically for people moving to Milwaukee. This isn't generic information—it's practical, actionable guidance you can use immediately.



What's Included:

- **✓ Cost of Living Calculator:** Interactive tool comparing your current city to Milwaukee with personalized results
- **✓ Neighborhood Fit Quiz:** Discover which Milwaukee neighborhoods align with your lifestyle priorities
- **✓ Home Buying Timeline:** Step-by-step process with key milestones and what to expect at each stage
- **✓ Vendor Directory:** Complete list of trusted professionals for every service you'll need
- **✓ Discovery Weekend Itinerary:** Suggested schedule for your Milwaukee visit to maximize neighborhood exploration
- **✓ School Comparison Guide:** Detailed profiles of districts and private school options



Bonus Resource

"Chicago vs. Milwaukee Budget Sheet" - Detailed expense comparison showing exactly how much you'll save monthly and annually by relocating. Includes housing, transportation, dining, entertainment, and more.

[Get My Free Toolkit](#)

Your Next Step

Let's Make Your Move Happen



Moving to Milwaukee doesn't have to be stressful or complicated. Whether you're still researching possibilities or ready to start viewing homes, I'll guide you every step of the way—virtually or in person.

My relocation service is designed specifically for out-of-state buyers who need more than just a traditional real estate agent. You need a local expert who understands the unique challenges of relocating and can provide comprehensive support throughout your transition.

Here's what happens next:

1. Schedule your free Relocation Strategy Call
2. We'll discuss your goals, timeline, and priorities
3. I'll create a customized Milwaukee relocation plan
4. You'll receive immediate access to your toolkit
5. We begin your journey to Milwaukee together



Schedule Your Call

 calendly.com/lucasmurphyrei

Book your free 30-minute Relocation Strategy Call



Explore Resources

 LucasMurphy.exprealty.com

Access market data, listings, and relocation guides



Get In Touch

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 (414) 458-1952

Direct contact for immediate questions

I look forward to helping you discover everything Milwaukee has to offer and making your relocation smooth, successful, and exciting.



Your Move. Your Milwaukee. Let's Make It Happen.

From Chicago to Cream City—I'll help you make the move with confidence, clarity, and complete support every step of the way.

Ready to Start Your Milwaukee Journey?

Schedule your free Relocation Strategy Call or
download your complete Move to Milwaukee Toolkit.

Schedule Call

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